SEMESTER 6 • COMMON COURSE • BILINGUAL HANDBOOK

Indian Constitution

A module-wise digital textbook built directly from Course Code 6002. It covers constitutional evolution, the Preamble, rights and duties, organs of government, local self-government, constitutional/statutory bodies, RTI and RTE, with short Malayalam support notes throughout.

COURSE CODE **6002**	COURSE TITLE **Indian Constitution**
SEMESTER **6**	CREDITS **No Credit**
CATEGORY **Common Course**	PERIODS / WEEK **2 (L:2, T:0, P:0)**
PERIODS / SEMESTER **30**	COGNITIVE LEVEL **Remembering / Understanding**

30

Total periods

Four course outcomes, fourteen syllabus units and two series-test periods.

COURSE PURPOSE

What this course develops

Constitutional awareness

Understand the history, basic values, structure and important features of the Constitution of India.

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Responsible citizenship

Relate Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles of State Policy and Fundamental Duties to responsible citizenship.

Fundamental Rights, DPSP, Fundamental Duties □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□.

Government institutions

Recognise the roles of Legislature, Executive and Judiciary at Union and State levels.

Union, State □□□□□□□□□□ Legislature, Executive, Judiciary □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□.

Local democracy

Understand Panchayat Raj, Nagarapalika institutions and the 73rd and 74th Amendments.

Panchayat Raj, Nagarapalika □□□□□□□□□□□, 73-□□, 74-□□ □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□.

Public bodies

Identify how the Election Commission, NHRC and Lok Ayukta influence public life.

Election Commission, NHRC, Lok Ayukta □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□.

Citizen-facing laws

Know the purpose of the Right to Information Act 2005 and Right to Education Act 2009.

RTI Act 2005, RTE Act 2009 □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□.

SYLLABUS STRUCTURE

Module and course-outcome map

The module hours total 28. Two additional series-test periods make the semester total 30.

CO1 / Module 1	**8 hours**
CO2 / Module 2	**5 hours + Test I**
CO3 / Module 3	**9 hours**
CO4 / Module 4	**6 hours + Test**

CO	Outcome	Duration	Cognitive Level
CO1	Describe the evolution and spirit of the Constitution and its basic principles.	8 hours	Understanding
CO2	Summarize the rights and duties of a responsible citizen.	5 hours	Understanding
CO3	Outline the various organs of government and their powers and functions.	9 hours	Understanding
CO4	Assimilate how constitutional and statutory bodies influence the everyday life of a citizen.	6 hours	Understanding

Prerequisite: Secondary-school Social Science. The syllabus maps all four course outcomes moderately to PO5.

CO1 • 8 HOURS

Module 1 — Evolution, Preamble and Salient Features

Describe the evolution and spirit of the Constitution and its basic principles.

1909
Constitutional reform listed in the syllabus.

1919
Further development of representative government.

1935
Major pre-Constitution administrative framework.

1947
Indian Independence Act and transition to independence.

M1.01 — 2 hours • Remembering

Constitution — definition and significance

A Constitution is the supreme framework of rules and principles that establishes government institutions, distributes powers, limits public authority and protects the relationship between the State and citizens. Its significance lies in providing legitimacy, stability, accountability and a common standard for governance.

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Supreme law | Government structure | Limited power | Citizen protection

M1.02 — 2 hours • Remembering

Evolution of the Indian Constitution

The syllabus traces constitutional evolution through the reforms of 1909, 1919 and 1935, followed by the Indian Independence Act 1947. Together, these stages show the gradual movement from colonial administration toward representative institutions and independent constitutional government.

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1. Remember the four years in order: 1909 → 1919 → 1935 → 1947.
2. Explain each as a stage in constitutional and representative development.

3 Conclude with the transition to an independent constitutional system.

M1.03

2 hours • Understanding

Preamble, basic principles and basic-structure debate

The Preamble introduces the source, nature, objectives and guiding values of the Constitution. Its core values are Justice, Liberty, Equality and Fraternity. The basic-structure idea means that constitutional amendment cannot destroy the Constitution's essential identity and foundational principles.

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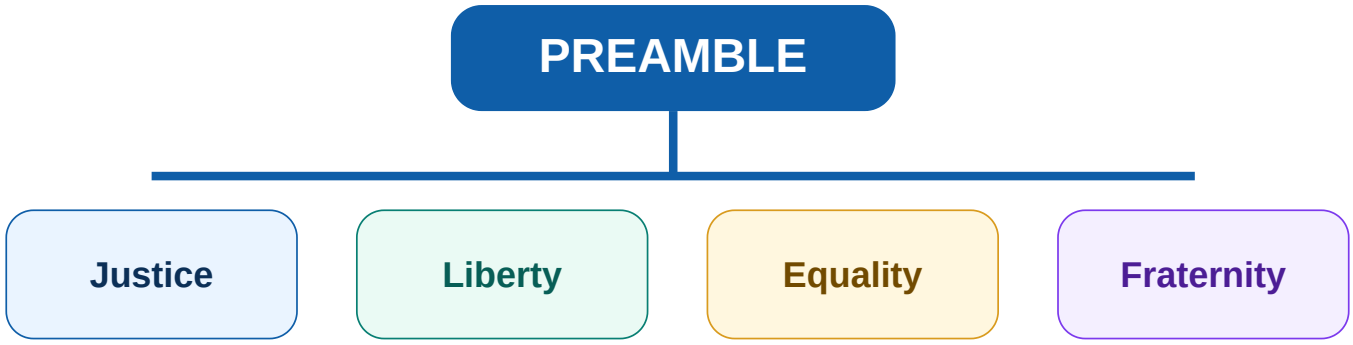

M1.04

2 hours • Understanding

Salient features of the Indian Constitution

- ✓ Written and detailed Constitution.
- ✓ Combination of rigidity and flexibility in amendment.
- ✓ Bicameral Legislature at the Union level.
- ✓ Federal distribution of powers with unitary features.
- ✓ Integrated judicial system.
- ✓ Single citizenship.
- ✓ Emergency provisions.

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Module 1 answer pattern: Begin with a definition, arrange the historical stages in order, identify the Preamble values, and finish with a classified list of salient features.

CO2 • 5 HOURS + SERIES TEST I

Module 2 — Fundamental Rights, DPSP and Fundamental Duties

Summarize the rights and duties of a responsible citizen.

M2.01

2 hours • Understanding

Part III — Fundamental Rights, Articles 12 to 35

Fundamental Rights protect individual freedom, equality and dignity. They are enforceable through courts. For study, group them into six broad classes.

Class	Articles	Core idea	Malayalam memory line
Right to Equality	14–18	Equality before law and removal of prohibited inequalities.	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□□□□.
Right to Freedom	19–22	Basic civil freedoms and safeguards relating to life, liberty and arrest.	□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□.
Right against Exploitation	23–24	Protection against trafficking, forced labour and child labour in prohibited work.	□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□.
Right to Freedom of Religion	25–28	Freedom of conscience and religious practice subject to constitutional limits.	□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□.
Cultural and Educational Rights	29–30	Protection of language, culture and minority educational interests.	□□□, □□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□.
Right to Constitutional Remedies	32	Approach the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights.	□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□.

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M2.02

1 hour • Understanding

Part IV — Directive Principles of State Policy

DPSP are constitutional directions to the State for building a just social order and guiding public policy. They are not directly enforceable by courts, but they are fundamental to governance and law-making.

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M2.03

1 hour • Understanding

Part IVA — Fundamental Duties, Article 51A

Fundamental Duties remind every citizen to respect the Constitution and national symbols, preserve unity, promote harmony, protect the environment, develop scientific temper, safeguard public property, strive for excellence and support education of children as constitutionally required.

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M2.04

1 hour • Understanding

Comparison — Fundamental Rights and DPSP

Point	Fundamental Rights	Directive Principles
Location	Part III	Part IV
Main focus	Individual freedom, equality and protection.	Social and economic goals of the State.
Enforceability	Enforceable through courts.	Not directly enforceable through courts.
Nature	Legal guarantees to citizens/persons as applicable.	Guidelines for policy and legislation.
Relationship	Both should be understood together: rights protect freedom while DPSP guides welfare-oriented governance.	

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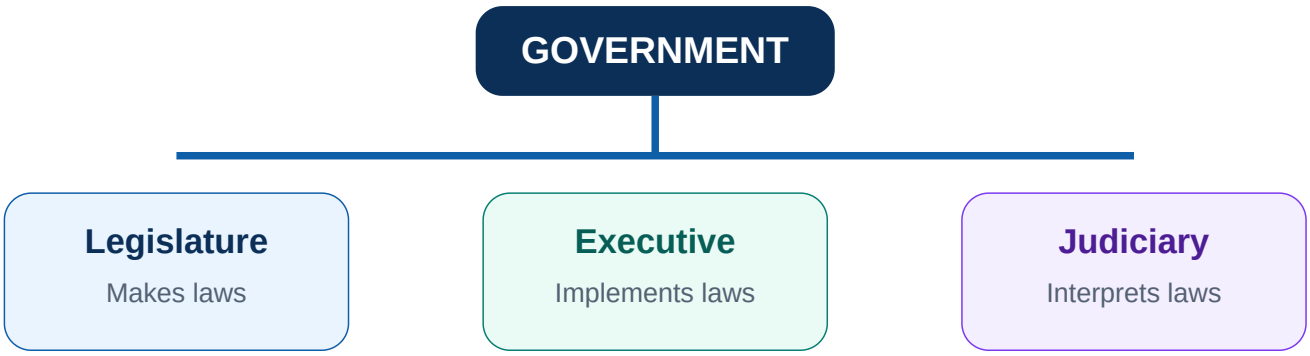
Series Test I focus: Article ranges, six classifications of Fundamental Rights, meaning of DPSP, Article 51A and the Rights–DPSP comparison.

CO3 • 9 HOURS

Module 3 — Legislature, Executive and Judiciary

Outline the organs of government and their powers and functions.



M3.01

3 hours • Understanding

Legislature — Union Parliament and State Legislature

Lok Sabha

House of the People. It represents the people directly and performs legislative, financial and accountability functions.

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Rajya Sabha

Council of States. It represents the States and participates in Union law-making and constitutional functions.

States-□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□. Union law-making-□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□.

Speaker

Presides over the Lok Sabha, maintains order, regulates proceedings and protects the authority of the House.

Lok Sabha □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□.

State Legislature: The syllabus includes the Legislative Assembly and, where applicable, the Legislative Council. Their core functions are State law-making, financial approval and accountability of the State Executive.

M3.02 3 hours • Understanding

Executive — Union and State

Level	Office / Institution	Main constitutional role
Union	President	Constitutional head of the Union; performs functions according to the constitutional system.
Union	Vice-President	Constitutional office with duties including the Rajya Sabha role.
Union	Prime Minister and Council of Ministers	Real executive leadership, policy direction and administration; collectively responsible in the parliamentary system.
State	Governor	Constitutional head of the State.
State	Chief Minister and Council of Ministers	Real executive leadership and administration at State level.

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M3.03 3 hours • Understanding

Judiciary — Supreme Court, High Court, Judicial Review and Independence

Supreme Court

Highest court in the integrated judicial system, constitutional guardian and final judicial authority within its jurisdiction.

High Court

Highest court at the State level, exercising constitutional and appellate functions within its jurisdiction.

Judicial Review

Power of courts to examine whether laws and executive actions conform to the Constitution.

Independence of Judiciary: Judicial decisions must be free from improper pressure so that the Constitution, rights and rule of law are protected impartially.

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High-score comparison: Legislature makes law, Executive administers and implements law, Judiciary interprets law and tests constitutional validity.

CO4 • 6 HOURS + SERIES TEST

Module 4 — Local Self-Government, Public Bodies, RTI and RTE

Understand how institutions and citizen-facing laws influence everyday life.

M4.01

2 hours • Understanding

Local Self-Government — 73rd and 74th Amendments

73rd Amendment — Panchayat Raj

Strengthens rural local self-government and democratic participation through Panchayat institutions.

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74th Amendment — Nagarapalika

Strengthens urban local self-government through municipal institutions.

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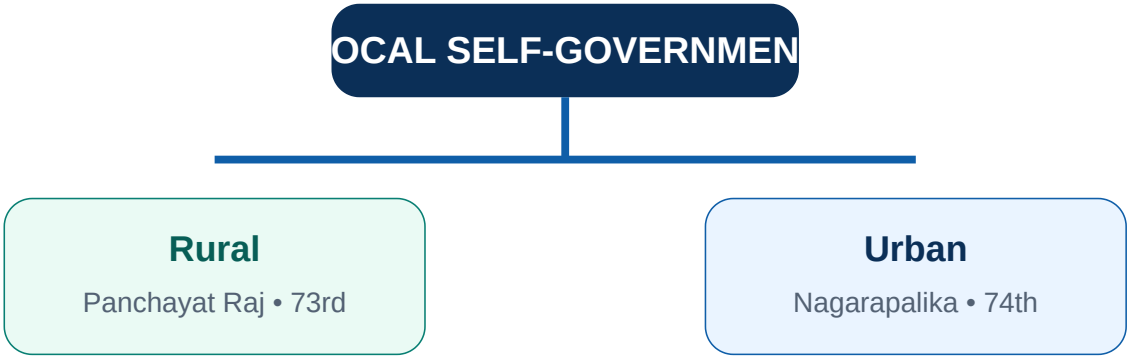

M4.02

2 hours • Understanding

Constitutional and Statutory Bodies

Body	Type	Everyday significance	Malayalam note
Election Commission	Constitutional body	Administers and safeguards the electoral process.	□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□.
National Human Rights Commission	Statutory body	Promotes and protects human-rights concerns within its legal mandate.	□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□.
Lok Ayukta	Statutory institution	Addresses complaints concerning public administration and corruption according to the applicable law.	□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□.

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M4.03

2 hours • Understanding

Right to Information Act 2005

RTI supports transparency and accountability by enabling citizens to seek information from public authorities according to the Act.

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M4.03

Included in 2 hours

Right to Education Act 2009

RTE provides a legal framework for the right of children to elementary education as prescribed by law.

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Series-test focus: 73rd versus 74th Amendment, constitutional versus statutory body, functions of Election Commission/NHRC/Lok Ayukta, RTI 2005 and RTE 2009.

FINAL REVISION SHEET

One-page memory map

Module 1

- Definition and significance
- 1909, 1919, 1935, 1947
- Preamble values
- Basic structure
- Salient features

Module 2

- Part III: Articles 12–35
- Six classes of rights
- Part IV: DPSP
- Part IVA: Article 51A
- Rights vs DPSP

Module 3

- Legislature makes laws
- Executive implements laws
- Judiciary interprets laws
- Union and State levels
- Judicial Review

Module 4

- 73rd: rural
- 74th: urban
- Election Commission
- NHRC and Lok Ayukta
- RTI 2005, RTE 2009

Malayalam last-day cue: □□□□□□□□ → □□□□□□□□□□ → □□□□□□□□□□/□□□□□□ → □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□ → local government → public bodies → RTI/RTE □□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□.

Likely 1-mark areas

- Define Constitution.
- Name Preamble values.
- State Article range of Part III.
- What is Article 51A?
- Name three organs of government.
- Which amendment relates to Panchayat Raj?

Likely short answers

- Significance of Constitution.
- Rights versus DPSP.
- Role of Speaker.
- Judicial Review.
- Constitutional versus statutory body.
- Purpose of RTI and RTE.

Likely long answers

- Evolution and salient features.
- Classification of Fundamental Rights.
- Union/State Legislature and Executive.
- Supreme Court, High Court and independence.
- 73rd/74th Amendments and local bodies.

MODEL QUESTION PAPER WITH COMPLETE ANSWERS

INDIAN CONSTITUTION • Practice Model • Maximum Marks: 75 • Time: 3 Hours

This is a fresh practice paper prepared from the syllabus topics. It is not an official question paper.

PART A — Answer all questions. Each carries 1 mark. [5 × 1 = 5]

1. Define Constitution.
2. Name any two values stated in the Preamble.

3. In which Part of the Constitution are Fundamental Duties placed?
4. Name the three organs of government.
5. Which constitutional amendment is associated with urban local self-government?

PART B — Answer any five. Each carries 8 marks. [5 × 8 = 40]

1. Explain the significance of a Constitution and outline the stages 1909, 1919, 1935 and 1947.
2. Explain the Preamble values and salient features of the Indian Constitution.
3. Classify Fundamental Rights and write the corresponding Article ranges.
4. Compare Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy.
5. Explain the composition and functions of the Union Parliament and State Legislature.
6. Explain the Union and State Executive.
7. Distinguish constitutional and statutory bodies. Add notes on Election Commission, NHRC and Lok Ayukta.

PART C — Answer any two. Each carries 15 marks. [2 × 15 = 30]

1. Explain Legislature, Executive and Judiciary at Union and State levels, including Judicial Review and independence of Judiciary.
2. Explain Fundamental Rights, DPSP and Fundamental Duties as the constitutional framework of responsible citizenship.
3. Explain local self-government under the 73rd and 74th Amendments, and discuss RTI Act 2005 and RTE Act 2009.

COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

Model-paper answers

Part A answers

No.	Answer
1	A Constitution is the supreme framework of rules and principles that establishes government, distributes and limits power, and regulates the relationship between the State and citizens.
2	Any two: Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity.
3	Part IVA, Article 51A.

No.	Answer
4	Legislature, Executive and Judiciary.
5	The 74th Constitutional Amendment.

Part B full answers

B1. Significance and evolution

Definition: The Constitution is the supreme framework of government.

Significance:
1. Creates the organs and institutions of government.
2. Distributes powers among institutions and levels of government.
3. Limits public power and promotes accountability.
4. Protects constitutional values and citizens.
5. Provides stability and a lawful method of change.

Evolutional outline:
• 1909 — an early constitutional reform stage listed in the syllabus.
• 1919 — a further stage in representative and administrative development.
• 1935 — a major pre-Constitution framework influencing governmental structure.
• 1947 — Indian Independence Act and the transition to independent government.

Conclusion: These stages show a gradual movement from colonial administration to independent constitutional governance.

B2. Preamble and salient features

The Preamble expresses the Constitution's source, nature, objectives and guiding values.

Core values:
1. Justice — social, economic and political fairness.
2. Liberty — freedom of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship within constitutional limits.
3. Equality — equal status and opportunity.
4. Fraternity — unity, dignity and common belonging.

Salient features:
• Written and detailed Constitution.
• Combination of rigidity and flexibility.
• Bicameral Union Legislature.
• Federal structure with unitary features.
• Integrated Judiciary.
• Single citizenship.
• Emergency provisions.

Basic-structure idea: amendment power cannot destroy the Constitution's essential identity.

Conclusion: The Preamble supplies the values, while the salient features show the working design of the Constitution.

B3. Classification of Fundamental Rights

Part III extends from Articles 12 to 35. The six principal classes are:
1. Right to Equality — Articles 14 to 18.
2. Right to Freedom — Articles 19 to 22.
3. Right against Exploitation — Articles 23 and 24.
4. Right to Freedom of Religion — Articles 25 to 28.
5. Cultural and Educational Rights — Articles 29 and 30.
6. Right to Constitutional Remedies — Article 32.

Fundamental Rights are enforceable through courts and protect freedom, equality and dignity.

B4. Fundamental Rights versus DPSP

Fundamental Rights:
• Located in Part III.
• Protect individual freedom, equality and dignity.
• Enforceable through courts.
• Operate as legal guarantees.

DPSP:
• Located in Part IV.
• Guide the State in social and economic policy.
• Not directly enforceable through courts.
• Operate as principles for governance and legislation.

Relationship: Rights protect liberty; DPSP guides welfare-oriented governance. Constitutional balance requires attention to both.

B5. Union Parliament and State Legislature

Union Parliament:
1. Lok Sabha — House of the People; directly represents citizens.
2. Rajya Sabha — Council of States; represents States.
3. Main functions — law-making, financial control, discussion of public policy and accountability of the Executive.
4. Speaker — presides over Lok Sabha, regulates proceedings and maintains order.

State Legislature:
1. Legislative Assembly is the principal elected House.
2. Legislative Council exists where constitutionally provided.
3. Functions include State law-making, financial approval and oversight of the State Executive.

Conclusion: The Legislature represents the people and States and converts public policy into law.

B6. Union and State Executive

Union Executive:
• President — constitutional head of the Union.
• Vice-President — constitutional office with the Rajya Sabha role.
• Prime Minister and Council of Ministers — real executive leadership, policy direction and administration.

State Executive:
• Governor — constitutional head of the State.
• Chief Minister and Council of Ministers — real executive leadership and State administration.

In the parliamentary system, the Council of Ministers exercises executive leadership while remaining responsible through the constitutional framework.

B7. Constitutional and statutory bodies

A constitutional body is created directly by the Constitution. A statutory body is created by legislation.

Election Commission:
• Constitutional body.
• Administers and safeguards the electoral process.

National Human Rights Commission:
• Statutory body.
• Promotes and protects human-rights concerns within its legal mandate.

Lok Ayukta:
• Statutory institution under applicable law.
• Examines complaints relating to public administration and corruption.

These bodies influence citizens through elections, rights protection and accountability mechanisms.

Part C full answers

C1. Three organs of government

Introduction: Constitutional government distributes major functions among Legislature, Executive and Judiciary.

A. Legislature
• Makes laws and represents citizens and States.
• Union: Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha and the parliamentary structure.
• State: Legislative Assembly and, where applicable, Legislative Council.
• Functions: law-making, financial control, debate and executive accountability.

B. Executive
• Implements laws and administers public policy.
• Union: President, Vice-President, Prime Minister and Council of Ministers.
• State: Governor, Chief Minister and Council of Ministers.
• The constitutional heads function within the parliamentary system; political executive leadership is exercised by the respective Councils of Ministers.

C. Judiciary
• Interprets law and resolves disputes.
• Supreme Court is the highest court; High Courts operate at State level.
• Judicial Review enables courts to test laws and executive action against the Constitution.
• Independence of Judiciary protects impartiality, rights and rule of law.

Conclusion: Functional separation with constitutional checks prevents concentration of power and supports accountable governance.

C2. Rights, DPSP and Duties

Introduction: Responsible citizenship combines protected rights, welfare-oriented State policy and citizen duties.

Fundamental Rights:
• Part III, Articles 12–35.
• Six classes: Equality, Freedom, against Exploitation, Freedom of Religion, Cultural and Educational Rights, Constitutional Remedies.
• Enforceable through courts.

Directive Principles of State Policy:
• Part IV.
• Guide the State toward social and economic justice and good governance.
• Not directly enforceable by courts.

Fundamental Duties:
• Part IVA, Article 51A.
• Require respect for the Constitution and national symbols, unity, harmony, environment, scientific temper, public property, excellence and educational responsibility.

Comparison and relationship:
• Rights protect the citizen.
• DPSP guides the State.
• Duties guide citizen conduct.

Conclusion: Together they form a balanced constitutional framework of liberty, welfare and responsibility.

C3. Local self-government, RTI and RTE

Local self-government brings democracy and administration closer to the people.

73rd Amendment:
• Relates to Panchayat Raj institutions in rural areas.
• Supports local participation and rural administration.

74th Amendment:
• Relates to Nagarapalika / municipal institutions in urban areas.
• Supports urban local administration and participation.

RTI Act 2005:
• Enables citizens to seek information from public authorities according to law.
• Promotes transparency and accountability.

RTE Act 2009:
• Gives a legal framework for children's right to elementary education as prescribed by law.

Citizen impact:
• Local bodies deliver and coordinate local public services.
• RTI strengthens informed participation.
• RTE advances access to elementary education.

Conclusion: The amendments and Acts deepen democracy by combining local participation, transparent administration and educational rights.

REFERENCES FROM THE SYLLABUS

Textbooks, references and online resources

Code	Book / Author
T1	B. L. Fadia, *The Constitution of India*, Sahitya Bhawan, New Delhi, 2017.
T2	D. D. Basu, *Introduction to Constitution of India*, LexisNexis, 23rd edition, 2018.
T3	M. V. Pylee, *India's Constitution*, Vikas, New Delhi, 2010.
T4	Bidyut Chakravarthy, *Indian Government and Politics*, Sage, New Delhi, 2008.
T5	Lakshmi Kanth, *Indian Polity*, Tata McGraw, 2010.
R1	Rajeev Bhargava, *Ethics and Politics of the Indian Constitution*, Oxford University Press, New Delhi, 2008.

Code	Book / Author
R2	Grenville Austin, *Indian Constitution: A Cornerstone of a Nation*, OUP, New Delhi, 2008.
R3	A. G. Noorani, *Constitutional and Citizen's Rights*, OUP, New Delhi, 2006.
R4	Henry C. Hart, "Indian Constitution: Political Development and Decay," *Asian Survey*, Vol. 20, No. 4, 1980, pp. 428–451.

Online resources listed in the syllabus: Constitution of India / india.gov.in; analysis of Constituent Assembly Debates / PRS India; "The Fifteen Women That Helped Draft the Indian Constitution" / Feminism in India.